

STAY SAFE, STAY SMART

Computer security and privacy protect personal photos, school records, financial data, and patient information. Prevent loss and misuse by recognizing threats and applying strong protections.



Think
before
you click

Verify
<https://> and
the lock

* *
Use
strong
passwords

Log out on
shared
devices

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COMPUTER SECURITY & PRIVACY BOOKLET

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COMPUTER SECURITY AND PRIVACY

PROTECTING WHAT MATTERS

From personal photos to school records, banking data, and hospital information



By Anirudh Vempati

A STUDENT GUIDE

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Threats to Computer and Data

The loss or leakage of computer or data can cause harm to individuals, schools, banks, hospitals, and other entities.



Theft

Physical theft
Identity theft



Software Piracy

Unlicensed software use
distribution



Worms

Self-replicate, spread rapidly across files



Online Predators

Posing as peers, coercion



Software Piracy

Unlicensed software use/
distribution



Viruses

Damages data/
steals info



Trojan Horse

Appears useful, destroys data inside



Internet Scams

Fake lotteries/
deposits;
money/data loss

Protecting Data: Practical Measures



Use Strong Passwords

- ✓ Mix lowercase, and uppercase letters, numbers, and special characters



Install Anti-virus and Firewall

- ✓ Monitor incoming and outgoing traffic
block threats, and detect and clean infections



Encrypt Data

- ✓ Whole-disk encryption (like Windows BitLocker) require a decryption key before startup



Use Secure Sites (HTTPS)

- ✓ Verify lock symbol and HTTPS when making payments or accessing sensitive info



Log out on shared computers



Update & backup regularly



Don't share OTPs or passwords